

Lipset 1959 RG Notes

Lipset, Seymour Martin. “Some Social Requisites of Democracy: Economic Development and Political Legitimacy” [1959].
American Political Science Review 53(1): 69-105.

Comparison to Mill’s system of logic (this paper criticizes political theorists for using a wealth of nonexamples to disprove virtually every available theory) – “deviant cases”

“A deviant case, considered within a context which marshals the evidence on all relevant cases, often may actually strengthen the basic hypothesis if an intensive study of it reveals the special conditions which prevented the usual relationship from appearing.⁴” (Lipset, 1959, p. 70)

“democracy (in a complex society) is defined as a political system which supplies regular constitutional opportunities for changing the governing official” (Lipset, 1959, p. 71)

again notes the importance of a legitimate opposition as a foundational cornerstone of legitimate democracy